

Fig. 26.8. Hawking conceding to Preskill and Thorne at a 1997 Caltech lecture by Hawking.

Despite our renewed bet, I doubt that naked singularities do exist in our universe. In *Interstellar*, Dr. Mann firmly asserts that "the laws of nature prohibit a naked singularity," and Professor Brand never even mentions that possibility. Instead, the Professor focuses on singularities inside black holes. Those, he thinks, are the only hope for learning the laws of quantum gravity.

The BKL Singularity Inside a Black Hole

EG

In Wheeler's era (the 1960s), we thought of a singularity inside a black hole as like a sharp point. A point that squeezes matter until the matter becomes infinitely dense and is destroyed. That's how, until now in this